

PERSON 3 PRESENTATION

# Real-World Cases & Ethical Issues

Examining how gender stereotypes impact real lives, workforce opportunities, and digital algorithms in Information Technology.

# Women in STEM & Technology

- 🔧 **Stereotypes in Tech:** STEM fields are often culturally framed as inherently male domains, creating subtle exclusion.
- 🎓 **Educational Barriers:** Young women face early discouragement, resulting in lower confidence in mathematics and engineering.
- 🏢 **Workplace Culture:** Isolation, lack of female mentorship, and underestimation of technical competence lead to high attrition.

## CENTRAL ETHICAL QUESTION

"Should someone's gender influence how we evaluate their scientific potential or technical capability?"



# Men in Nursing & Caregiving

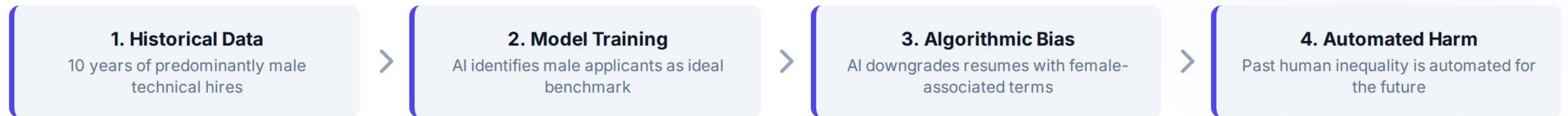


-  **Caregiving Stigma:** Nursing and primary education are frequently labeled as "women's work," creating social resistance.
-  **Career Pressure:** Men entering healthcare encounter assumptions that they lacked ambition for higher-paying "masculine" roles.
-  **Universal Impact:** Stereotypes do not just restrict women—they restrict everyone's personal freedom and fulfillment.

## ETHICAL TENSION

"How do rigid social expectations limit an individual's autonomy in selecting a fulfilling career path?"

# Algorithmic Bias in **AI Recruitment**



## ⚠️ Real-World Example: Amazon's AI Hiring Tool

An automated resume-screening tool penalized applications containing words like *"women's chess club captain"* or graduates of all-female colleges because it was trained on historical data dominated by men.

### CORE DILEMMA OF IT ETHICS

"When an AI recruitment tool discriminates, who holds moral accountability—the developer, the employer, the data, or society?"

# Ethical Analysis of Gender Bias



## Fairness

Treating individuals equitably without arbitrary barriers or systemic disadvantages based on gender identity.



## Equality of Opportunity

Ensuring career and educational access are dictated purely by capability, merit, and interest rather than societal expectations.



## Autonomy

Empowering individuals with the agency and freedom to make career choices without fear of social penalty or bias.



## Non-Discrimination

Preventing human decisions and technological algorithms from unfairly excluding underrepresented groups.



## Accountability

Requiring organizations and software developers to actively audit and take responsibility for biased systems.



## Key Conclusion

Stereotypes cease to be harmless when they convert into systemic discrimination and algorithmic bias.

# Interactive Scenario: The Hiring AI

## Scenario Statement:

A software corporation deploys an AI hiring tool. After 6 months, statistics show the tool shortlisted **70% male and 30% female candidates**.

Engineers argue the model is mathematically objective because it simply mirrors 10 years of successful internal hiring data.

## Questions for the Class:

- ❓ Should the company suspend this algorithm immediately?
- ❓ Is replicating historical data truly "objective" or automated bias?
- ❓ Who holds final responsibility: the engineers, company leaders, or data?

→ **Transition to Person 4:** *"AI can reproduce historical human stereotypes—but can technology also become our strongest tool for breaking them?"*

## Section 3: Key Takeaways

- ✓ **Real World Impact:** Gender stereotypes are not abstract ideas; they restrict career growth and cause tangible economic and personal harm.
- ✓ **Affects All Genders:** From STEM barriers for women to caregiving stigma for men, gender stereotypes limit everyone's potential.
- ✓ **Digital Amplification:** Unchecked historical data in AI systems automates past human bias into systematic future discrimination.
- ✓ **Ethical Imperative:** Technology developers and business leaders have a proactive obligation to embed fairness into systems.



# Image Sources



[https://static.vecteezy.com/system/resources/previews/043/238/260/large\\_2x/female-robotics-engineer-working-with-programming-and-manipulating-robot-hand-industrial-robotics-design-high-tech-facility-modern-machine-learning-mass-production-automatics-free-photo.jpg](https://static.vecteezy.com/system/resources/previews/043/238/260/large_2x/female-robotics-engineer-working-with-programming-and-manipulating-robot-hand-industrial-robotics-design-high-tech-facility-modern-machine-learning-mass-production-automatics-free-photo.jpg)

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